

## Sales Training — Session 37

# Dream Like A Child.

## Execute Like A Wolverine.

Wednesday 17 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

**WHAT THIS SESSION IS** At some point, most adults stop dreaming — not because they want to, but because life slowly trains them out of it. This session is about reclaiming that ability, combining it with the relentless follow-through that turns vision into reality, and recognising the predictable obstacles (the walls, the money critique, the excuses, the ghost) that try to talk you out of both.

### 1. The problem most adults don't realise they have

At some point in most adult lives, dreaming stops. Not deliberately — almost nobody chooses to stop dreaming. Life simply trains it out of them gradually. They become practical. They become realistic. They become cautious. They start each new idea by listing reasons it won't work, and somewhere in the listing the idea quietly dies. After enough years of this pattern, the practical part of the brain takes the wheel permanently and the dreaming part atrophies from disuse.

The problem is that almost everything worth building started as a dream first. The business plan was a daydream before it was a document. The house was an image before it was a mortgage. The career was an ambition before it was a CV. Without the dreaming part of the brain doing its job, the adult brain is left with execution capacity it has nothing meaningful to apply itself to. The result is competence directed at small things — which produces a small life.

*"Adults stop dreaming. Not because they want to. Because life slowly teaches them not to. And before long, they stop imagining what's possible."*

### 2. Children dream differently — what we lost

Compare adults to children of seven or eight. Ask a child what they want to be and the answers come without filter — astronaut, pilot, business owner, athlete, millionaire, footballer, surgeon, all in the same conversation. The child doesn't pre-validate the answer. They don't calculate whether the dream is realistic, whether the path exists, whether they're the kind of person who could do it. They simply imagine.

That ability isn't naive — it's powerful. Every achievement starts as an idea before it becomes reality. The child has the capacity to generate ideas freely; the adult has the capacity to execute. The reason most adults end up underliving their potential is that they kept the executor and fired the idea generator. They can do anything they decide to do. They just no longer decide anything big enough to be worth doing.

*"A child can imagine becoming an astronaut, a pilot, a business owner, a millionaire — without immediately calculating whether it's realistic. That's a powerful ability. Every achievement starts as an idea before it becomes reality."*

The move is to consciously reactivate the seven-year-old. Not to abandon the executor — the executor is essential. But to let the seven-year-old back into the meeting where the goals get set. The seven-year-old picks the destination. The adult plans the journey. Both halves are required.

### 3. The walls are lies

A phrase from the session worth memorising. "The walls are lies." The walls are the limitations the rep believes are real — the current size of the team, the apparent ceiling on income, the geographic constraints, the qualifications they don't have. Most of those walls aren't structural reality. They're assumptions, stories, beliefs, predictions about what might happen. They feel solid because the rep has stopped questioning them.

Corie's grounding example: when he was a child, his bedroom was his parents' lounge room — that was what the walls told him about his future. Three decades later, the walls are very different. The walls weren't lying back then; they just weren't predictive. The current walls in any rep's life have the same property. They describe what is, not what will be. They feel like the truth because they're physically present. They're not the truth — they're snapshots.

*"The walls are lies. Most of the limitations people believe in aren't real. They're assumptions. Stories. Beliefs. Predictions. And often they only exist because we've accepted them without questioning them."*

Practical move: name the wall you're treating as truth right now. "The market is dead." "I'm not qualified for that." "My commission is capped." "There's no room to grow here." Write it down. Then call bullshit on it. The wall describes a moment, not a future. Follow the discipline anyway. The wall has no choice but to change.

### 4. The money critique — talking down what you can't reach

A direct and uncomfortable part of the session. People who can't reach a thing have a reliable tendency to attack it. The rep who can't yet earn the income they want will gradually develop a critique of wealth itself. The colleague who hasn't built the career will develop a critique of ambition. The friend who hasn't taken the risk will develop a critique of risk-taking. The criticisms are dressed up as wisdom — and they sound like wisdom — but they're usually defence mechanisms.

This matters operationally because the rep can fall into the same trap. The moment a rep convinces themselves that money is unimportant, success is shallow, or ambition is unhealthy, they stop pursuing it — and once they stop pursuing it, they don't reach it, which confirms the critique they used to justify stopping. The loop closes. Five years later they

have all the evidence they need that wealth wasn't worth chasing, when the actual reason they don't have it is that they stopped chasing it.

*"People often attack things they haven't figured out how to reach yet. And that's dangerous. Because the moment you convince yourself something is bad, you stop pursuing it."*

The corrective frame: notice the critique when it arrives. Notice whose mouth it comes out of. Notice when it comes out of your own mouth. None of this means the rep has to chase money over everything else. But the rep needs to be honest about the difference between "I'm choosing something else" and "I've decided this thing isn't worth wanting because I haven't yet figured out how to get it." The first is a choice. The second is a trap.

## 5. Dream first. Work out the path later.

Most people reverse the natural order. They get the idea, and immediately ask: how? When? What if it doesn't work? What if I fail? What if it's harder than I can handle? Those questions feel responsible. They're actually fatal. They kill the dream before it has a chance to live, because the rep is trying to solve a problem ("how do I get there?") for a destination that hasn't yet been allowed to exist properly.

The order that actually works is the reverse. Allow yourself to imagine the destination first. Let it be specific. Let it be vivid. Let it sit in your head long enough to become real to you. Then — and only then — start solving the problems one at a time. The path almost never emerges from "what's possible from where I am?" It emerges from "where do I want to be?" followed by working backwards. Reps who reverse the order keep ending up exactly where they already are, because that's what the planning approach optimises for.

*"Dream first. Work out the path later. Most people reverse the process. They ask how before they've finished imagining where. The questions kill the dream before it has a chance to live."*

## 6. It's none of your business how you get there

A counterintuitive principle that took Corie years to internalise and which he now treats as binding. Once the destination is clear, the rep doesn't need to know the path in advance. They don't need to map the next 20 steps. They don't need certainty about how every obstacle gets cleared. "How you get there" is, in a real sense, none of their business — it's the universe's business. The rep's business is to be clear about where they're going and to keep moving.

This sounds mystical. It isn't. It's a practical observation about how careers actually unfold. Nobody who built something meaningful had the whole plan in their head when they started. They had a direction. The path emerged from sustained motion toward the direction. Opportunities, contacts, breaks, lucky tangents — none of those are visible in advance. They become visible only when the rep is already in motion and looking for them.

*"It's none of your business how you get there. People want every answer, every step, every certainty before they begin. Life rarely works that way."*

Practical move: stop demanding to see the whole path. Pick the destination. Take the first step. Watch what the first step reveals about the second step. The path doesn't appear all at once. It appears in 5-foot sections as the rep walks forward. Stopping until the whole path is visible is how reps stay exactly where they are for the rest of their lives.

## 7. Excuses always arrive — predictability is the point

Every dream that goes far enough will at some stage become difficult. When it does, the excuses arrive on schedule. They're not novel. They're not even varied. They show up in roughly the same order every time, regardless of what the dream is.

The excuses look like:

- Maybe you're not smart enough.
- Maybe you're too old.
- Maybe you're too young.
- Maybe you're too busy.
- Maybe it's too difficult.
- Maybe it isn't worth it.

Each one feels uniquely yours when it arrives — it's been tailored to your specific doubts, your specific weaknesses. That tailoring is what makes it persuasive. But the excuses arrive for everyone, in roughly the same order, with roughly the same content. The question isn't whether the excuses are going to arrive. They will. The question is whether you believe them.

*"Every dream eventually reaches a difficult stage. And when it does, the excuses arrive. They always arrive. The question is whether you believe them."*

## 8. The ghost — expect it

The session named the experience that's specifically dangerous: the moment, mid-pursuit, when the voice arrives. The voice says stop. The voice says it won't work. The voice says the rep should lower their expectations and settle for something more realistic. The voice usually arrives with perfect timing — just when the rep is about to push through a difficult patch, just when the breakthrough is closer than it feels.

Corie calls this the ghost. Naming it matters. Once it has a name, the rep recognises it as the thing it is — a predictable visitor, not a wise counsellor. It's the same ghost that talks every adult out of pursuing the dream. It says different words to different people, but it's the same entity doing the same job. Its job is to stop you. Your job, when it shows up, is to keep going anyway.

*"The ghost gets in your head. It tells you it's not everything. It tells you it doesn't matter that much. It tells you no one will know if you just don't bother. Get it done anyway."*

The discipline: expect the ghost. Don't be surprised when it arrives. Don't argue with it — arguing keeps it in the room longer. Notice it. Note that it's the same ghost everyone meets. And keep going. The ghost loses its power the moment it stops being a surprise.

## 9. Don't decide whether you'll enjoy something before you've earned the right

A specific cognitive trap worth naming. Most adults will start something new, feel uncomfortable in the first weeks (because everything new is uncomfortable), and decide at that point that they don't enjoy it. They walk away. The decision feels like self-knowledge — "I tried it, I didn't like it." It's actually self-deception.

The honest version of the verdict requires having earned the right to make it. That means becoming competent first. Quitting at week three doesn't tell you whether the work is enjoyable — it tells you that the beginner version is uncomfortable, which everyone already knew. To find out whether you actually enjoy something, you have to do it long enough to be reasonably good at it. Quitting before that point isn't a verdict on the activity. It's an exit dressed up as a verdict.

*"Don't decide whether you'll enjoy something before you've earned the right to decide. Too many people judge the experience before they've become competent. And too many walk away before the rewards arrive."*

Applied to sales: the rep at week three who decides cold calling isn't for them hasn't actually tried cold calling. They've tried being bad at cold calling, which is a different experience. The verdict requires reaching reasonable competence — and reasonable competence requires the 100 days. Once you've done the 100 days, you can credibly decide whether the work is for you. Before that, you're just deciding whether being a beginner feels good. The answer to that is no, for everyone, always.

## 10. Dream like a child. Execute like a Wolverine.

The session's central image. Two completely different capacities, both required, used in sequence. The seven-year-old picks the destination — without filter, without pre-validation, without the protective questions that adults add to kill the idea before it forms. The Wolverine does the execution — relentless, refusing to die on the way, treating every obstacle as something to be ground through rather than reconsidered.

Neither half works alone. The seven-year-old without the Wolverine produces a life full of half-finished dreams — exciting starts that fade when the work gets hard. The Wolverine without the seven-year-old produces a life full of grinding competence applied to nothing worth the effort. Combined, they're the most powerful career engine available to anyone.

*"Combine a dream like a seven-year-old with the determination of a Wolverine. Imagination without action becomes fantasy. Action without imagination becomes routine. The combination of both is incredibly powerful."*

Practical move: every rep should be doing both halves consciously. Reserve time for the seven-year-old — the part that picks the dream and lets it be vivid. Reserve time for the Wolverine — the part that handles the daily, repetitive, unglamorous work that turns the dream into the reality. Most reps neglect one or the other. The rare reps who do both are the rare reps who build the careers.

## 11. Build a future bigger than the limits you once believed in

Pulling the threads together. The walls in front of every rep right now are real in the moment but not predictive of the future. The excuses that will arrive when the work gets hard are predictable — same excuses, same order, same content as everyone else's. The ghost that whispers "settle for less" is real but defeatable once it has a name. The path forward won't always be obvious, especially in advance — but it doesn't need to be.

None of this changes the destination. Reps who allow themselves to dream, who refuse the walls, who name the ghost when it arrives, who refuse to decide whether they enjoy the work before they're good at it — those reps build futures bigger than the limits they once believed in. The limits were never the truth. The destination was. The Wolverine work, sustained over years, is what closes the gap between the two.

*"Extraordinary results rarely belong to the people with the best circumstances. They belong to the people who keep moving toward a dream long after everyone else has stopped."*

## 12. Action items for the team

1. Spend 15 quiet minutes this week consciously reactivating the seven-year-old. Write down what you'd want — without filter, without pre-validating — if there were no walls.
2. Name one wall you're currently treating as truth. Write it down. Then write underneath it: "This describes now. It doesn't predict the future."
3. When you catch yourself critiquing wealth, ambition, or success — pause. Ask whether you're choosing something else or whether you're rationalising not pursuing the thing you actually want.
4. Pick one destination. Take the FIRST step. Don't demand to see steps 2-20. Watch what the first step reveals.
5. Print the predictable excuses ("too smart, too old, too busy, too difficult, not worth it") and tape them somewhere visible. When they arrive — and they will — recognise them as the predictable visitors they are.
6. Give the ghost a name. "That's the ghost." Three words. Recognise. Then keep going.

7. If you're tempted to quit something within the first 30 days, ask yourself whether you're judging the activity or judging the beginner experience of the activity. They're not the same thing.
8. Reserve time for both halves. The seven-year-old picks the destination. The Wolverine handles the work. Neither half alone produces the life.

**THE RULE OF THUMB** The walls are lies. The excuses are predictable. The ghost will arrive on schedule. None of these are obstacles to the dream — they're the test of how much you wanted the dream in the first place. Dream like a child. Execute like a Wolverine. Build a future bigger than the limits you once believed in.